of a thought needs to be confirmed by another thought; and that if two items are joined by a real relation (a third factor), further relations are required to relate the primary relation to the two items and so forth.

Anekanta-vada: while ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika*** develops a complex scheme of categories (***padartha***) in terms of which we may make sense of objects in the cosmos, ***Jainism*** claims that we can understand entities using just two factors of analysis: permanence (***dravya***) and change (*paryaya*). ***Dravya*** means what is unitary and constant. *Paryayas* are particular states that may be present or absent in substances. Reality is too complex to be pinned down in categorical schemes involving strict boundaries. Objects are constants *and* variables. Moreover, given that we are not omniscient, we are not in a position to frame an absolutely correct conception about anything. All our understanding is partial and from a limited perspective. The Jains attempt to convey the ambiguity or indeterminacy of reality relative to human viewpoints in the following logical scheme (where 'it' stands for anything and the square brackets for any feature):

1. In a sense, it is [. . .]
2. In a sense, it is not [. . .]
3. In a sense, it both is [. . .] and is not [. . .]
4. In a sense, it is inexpressible
5. In a sense, it is [. . .] and is inexpressible
6. In a sense, it is not [. . .] and it is inexpressible
7. In a sense, it is [. . .] and is not [. . .], and it is inexpressible.

Take the question of whether the soul is embodied. The following are rationally defensible points of view. In a sense, it is. In a sense, it is not (because it can exist